ITEC320 Placement - Week 3 Contribution Report

Student Name	Alisha
Student Number	S00391669
Project	ShieldSense - Accessible Scam-Message Screening Application
Role	Interface & Accessibility Lead
Week	Week 3

1. Weekly Contribution

During Week 3 of the ShieldSense project, my main contribution focused on the initial development of the user interface. As the Interface & Accessibility Lead, my responsibility is to ensure that the application is simple, clear, responsive and accessible for users who want to check potentially suspicious messages.

I worked on planning and developing the main ShieldSense screening page. The interface includes an area where users can enter or paste a suspicious SMS, email or other message and submit it for screening. I also worked on the structure for presenting the screening result clearly to the user.

2. Interface Development

The interface was designed around a simple workflow: **Enter suspicious message -> Check message -> Display risk result -> Provide explanation and recommended action.**

The result section was planned to display three possible risk levels:
- **Green - Low Risk:** No major scam indicators detected.
- **Amber - Caution:** Some suspicious characteristics detected and the user should verify the message.
- **Red - High Risk:** Strong scam indicators detected and the user should avoid interacting with the message.

I ensured that the risk level would not be communicated through colour alone. Each result also includes a text label, explanation and appropriate guidance so that the information remains understandable for users with colour-vision difficulties.

3. Sample Data and Interface Testing

I prepared sample messages representing Green, Amber and Red risk categories so that the interface can be tested before the final scam-detection model is integrated.

Example test messages include normal personal or appointment messages for Green results, unexpected verification or account-warning messages for Amber results, and messages requesting passwords, bank details, gift cards or urgent payments for Red results.

This sample data allows me to test whether different screening results are presented correctly and consistently through the user interface.

4. Accessibility Considerations

Accessibility remained an important part of my Week 3 contribution. I considered relevant WCAG 2.2 AA principles while planning the interface, including:
- Clear and readable text

- Descriptive labels for input fields
- Keyboard-accessible controls
- Appropriate text and background contrast
- Clear buttons and instructions
- Text labels alongside Green, Amber and Red colours
- Responsive presentation for different screen sizes

These considerations will continue to be reviewed as the interface develops.

5. Team Collaboration

My interface work depends on collaboration with the Model & Evaluation Lead and the Integration, Documentation & QA Lead. The final screening model will provide the risk classification, while my interface will be responsible for displaying that result clearly to the user.

During development, I will ensure that the interface can accept the model output and display the appropriate risk level, explanation and recommended user action.

6. Evidence of Week 3 Contribution

Evidence that can be retained for my placement portfolio includes screenshots of the ShieldSense interface, message-input page, Green/Amber/Red result designs, sample testing data, VS Code development progress, Git/GitHub commits if used, and notes from team or supervisor feedback.

7. Next Steps

In the next stage of the project, I will continue developing and improving the ShieldSense interface. I will focus on making the message-input and result components functional, improving the visual design, testing responsiveness on different screen sizes, checking accessibility, and preparing the interface for integration with the scam-screening model.

Overall, Week 3 established the foundation of my individual technical contribution to ShieldSense and prepared the interface for further development, accessibility testing and model integration.